

Tobias Treppmann

Design leader who still designs — a team, a design system across surfaces, and hands on the work every week

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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PORTFOLIO

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
Completed 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

SKILLS

Design Leadership

Team of five including a design lead at Ninox, on the Senior Leadership Team · Hired two, promoted two, and made the call when someone was not the right fit · Interim Head of Product for four months · Coached a design lead through a strained engineering relationship rather than around it · Design-thinking training for executive leadership and service teams at Hypoport

Product Ownership, Not Only Aesthetics

Held product management for the main platform alongside all product design at ChurchDesk · Wrote the specs and ran the ticket board engineering worked from · Interim Head of Product at Ninox · Owned the build-versus-buy and standalone-versus-embedded decisions and held the second one through delivery · 70% coordination-time reduction and 90% booking acceptance at the launch customer

Design Systems Across Surfaces

Design system as an API at Bibel TV: DTCG tokens in four tiers (primitives, semantic, component, page and view), built with Style Dictionary and platform-agnostic, serving iOS, Android, web and connected TV from one source · One commit propagates to every platform that consumes it · Co-built the Datameer system, defining component behavior and specs across the library · Governance run as a cross-functional working group with assigned members and an escalation path

PROFILE

I lead design functions and I stay in the craft. Fifteen years in B2B software, most of it vertical products for people who did not choose to be software users: analysts inside banks, parish offices, funeral directors. I have run a team of five, held product management and all of product design at the same time, and built a design system that ships as an API rather than a Figma file. The last year went into AI that runs in production rather than AI that demos.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web, connected TV) Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- Prototype in real code, and the agency ships from them. Web first, then Android, running against real APIs rather than clickable mockups. The handoff crosses a company boundary and still holds.
- I write the specs and run the board. The tickets engineering works from are mine to write and prioritize, and I check the built feature in production and beta rather than calling it done at handoff.
- AI support copilot, live in production. Assistive drafting for viewer letters in the handbook's wording. An explicit restricted-topic list sits in the system prompt, the draft is suppressed when the input is not a viewer enquiry, and every send decision stays human. Operated manually, and adoption was optional.
- AI fundraising ecosystem, built solo end to end. Analysis, prompt architecture, prototype, then a production Claude skill generating follow-up content across in-app, web and video.
- Design system as an API — DTCG tokens, Style Dictionary, multi-platform sync. Built without a platform team, so that consistency holds structurally instead of by asking people.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP for churches and dioceses — DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Designer and product manager at once. Product management for the main platform plus all product design. I wrote the specs, ran the ticket board engineering worked from, and was the main customer-facing contact for the launch parish throughout.
- Booking built into the platform rather than beside it. On the existing calendar and form builder, so the same build carried room rentals, baptisms and weddings. 70% coordination-time reduction, 90% acceptance, then shipped to every customer.
- Led all product design across the company, and held product management for the main platform beside it.
- Compliance shipped as a feature. Churches host their websites on the platform and were given a legal accessibility deadline; what we shipped met it for them automatically, across six countries.
- Two engineers, two months, daily contact. Design in Figma, build in code, and I was in the build every day rather than at the end of it.

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) Berlin, Germany

- Research at a scale a team cannot read — Claude over thousands of forum posts for sentiment, pain points and feature requests, with Dovetail as the shared repository. Above a few hundred data points that analysis happens or it does not happen at all; below it, I read the responses.
- Senior Leadership Team, 5 direct reports including a design lead — I owned the design system and established joint governance with engineering.

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport hub SE (shared services arm of listed Hypoport SE) Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-product transformation. Partnered with the executive team to productize the service organization. Case-by-case support became a standard catalog.
- Methodology transfer. Ran design-thinking training for executive leadership and service teams.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Five years of data-dense B2B desktop interfaces. Big-data pivot tables, column charts, aggregated JSON views, result cards and filter logic. The hardest of them was the query-builder preview, where the result you see is a sample and the interface has to be honest about that without becoming unreadable.
- Research inside institutions that make users hard to reach. Pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to get to analysts working inside banks and insurers. The platform operated under HIPAA compliance among other frameworks.
- Led the design team across Germany and NYC for five years. Two UX designers reporting to me. A six-hour gap, held together by cross-timezone collaboration processes I established.
- Design system — I defined component behavior and specs across the library.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Brand as a System

Built Bibel TV's color engine: a custom color-extraction API and config tool, live in production, deriving image-based card gradients perceptually from content artwork with k-means and OKLCH, holding WCAG contrast in both light and dark · The machinery that makes a visual language hold across content nobody has seen yet · Selah — Mindful Transitions: a macOS app designed, built and shipped solo on the Mac App Store, including the product, the interface, the icon and the store listing

Hands-On Craft

Prototyped in real code against real production APIs, web first then Android · Iteration moved from days of spec-and-handoff to hours in working code · Engineering at Bibel TV is an external agency, so that handoff crosses a company boundary and holds anyway · Complex systems simplified into usable interfaces: the query-builder preview shows a sample, and the interface has to say so without becoming unreadable

AI-First Practice

Claude Code, Claude Projects and Claude skills as daily tools, plus Zed · A support copilot live in production for viewer services · An AI fundraising ecosystem built solo end to end, from analysis through prompt architecture and prototype to a production skill · the capability that let customers meet a legal accessibility deadline automatically · “Designing with and for AI” workshop series run since 2024 with a partner agency

Customers Who Are Not Software People

Funeral directors, parish assistants and priests at ChurchDesk, three stakeholder groups with opposing needs on one surface · Recurring validation calls with the launch customer's project lead throughout delivery · Analysts inside top US, Canadian and UK banks and insurers at Datameer · Research access into regulated enterprises that had never granted it · Regular customer interviews I run myself — funeral directors, parish assistants and priests, three groups with opposing needs on one surface, turned into product decisions

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

Design Consultant · [Ninox Software GmbH](#) · Summer 2025 · freelance · prompt-to-database AI onboarding

UX Strategy Lead · [Spreadshirt](#) · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig, Germany

UX Manager · [HairDirect](#) · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · [andCulture](#) · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · [HOPE International](#) · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

Web Designer · [Bajaa.com](#) · 2008 – 2009 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Düsseldorf, Germany

Web Designer · [Bajaa.com](#) · 2000 – 2003 · Düsseldorf, Germany

E-Commerce Assistant · [Westfalia Werkzeugcompany](#) · 1999 · Hagen, Germany